AEP FROM ZERO • PART 1 • KNOW YOUR CUSTOMER (AEP)

EPISODE 04

AEP Schema Tutorial: Identities and Profile

Learn how to create a schema in Adobe Experience Platform (AEP) step by step, with the identities and the Profile switch that turn rows into people. Bloom's team builds three XDM schemas, creates a custom identity namespace and chooses its type, and shows why email, not the ECID, is the primary identity on the customer profile. You will see why the order event carries two identities, why Apply is not Save in the schema editor, and why Enable for Profile is irreversible and needs its own save. Finally,

Previously: two Priyas on paper

- Last time: three schemas designed on paper
- The platform still sees two Priyas
- Today: build them for real in a dev sandbox
- Choose identities, then switch on Profile
- Prove it from one screen, not a message

KEY IDEA

Kavya's paper model becomes three real schemas today, and each one must declare which field says who the customer is.

An email field is not an identity

- A field holding an email is still just text
- Identity: this value names a person
- Mapping fills fields; the schema declares identities
- No identity: rows land, but no profile is built
- A schema without a primary identity is a spreadsheet

KEY IDEA

A field that holds an email is just text until the schema declares it an identity. Identities are what turn rows into people.

What is an identity namespace?

Namespace	Owner	What it names
Email	Standard	An email address
ECID	Standard	A browser or app install
BloomID	Custom	Bloom's customer number

Identities, Namespaces tab (as of 2026)

KEY IDEA

An identity namespace answers one question: what kind of ID is this string? Bloom uses Email, ECID and its own custom BloomID.

Namespace types are permanent

Namespace type	Identifies
Cookie ID	A browser
Individual cross-device ID	A person: a CRM or login ID
Hardware device ID	A device
Non-people identifiers	Things like a SKU; off the graph

The type is permanent. A namespace cannot be renamed or deleted.

KEY IDEA

Each namespace has a permanent type saying what it identifies. Bloom's customer number names a person, so BloomID is an Individual cross-device ID.

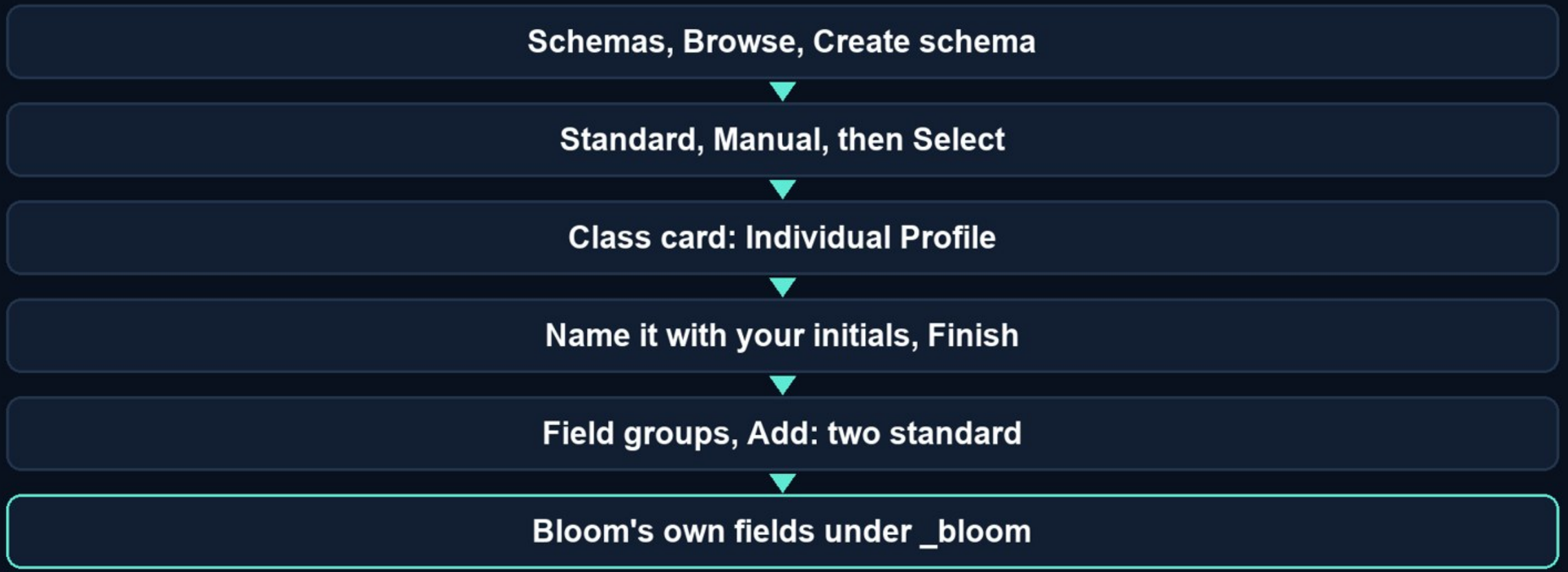
Primary identity: why email beats ECID

- Primary identity: the main key for the person
- Only one primary identity per schema
- ECID: an anonymous wristband per browser or app
- A shared family tablet: three people, one wristband
- Email follows the person across devices
- Bloom: Email is primary on the customer profile

KEY IDEA

The primary identity is the main key for the person. On Bloom's customer profile it is email, because email follows the human and an ECID does not.

Building Bloom Customer Profile



KEY IDEA

In Schemas, Browse, Create schema, Kavya builds Bloom Customer Profile on the Individual Profile class with two standard field groups.

Apply is not Save

Click personalEmail.address

▼

Tick Identity

▼

Identity namespace: Email

▼

Tick Primary identity

▼

Scroll down, click Apply

▼

Save, then find the fingerprint

KEY IDEA

Identity, namespace, Primary, Apply, then Save. Apply commits the field panel and Save commits the schema. Miss Apply and the identity never exists.

The web event and two small traps

- Class: Experience Event
- Field group: Consumer Experience Event
- New field group: Bloom Web Identity
- visitorId, type String, ECID, primary
- Trap: the display name auto-fills and appends
- Trap: '(New)' creates a duplicate field group

KEY IDEA

Bloom Web Event uses the Experience Event class and a custom visitor ID field marked as an ECID identity. Two editor traps wait on the way.

The order event carries two identities

Schema field	Namespace	Identity?
Order: bloomId	BloomID (custom)	Yes, primary
Order: orderEmail	Email	Yes, second identity
Profile: email address	Email	Yes, primary
Profile: BloomID	none	No, a plain attribute

KEY IDEA

Bloom Order Event marks bloomId as primary and orderEmail as a second identity. The shared email lets orders attach to the right profile.

Check the design on paper first

- Profile sample: email primary, loyalty under _bloom
- Its identityMap also lists BloomID: a teaching shape
- Web sample: _id, timestamp, ECID only
- Order sample: two line items, email and BloomID
- Order sample marks Email primary; schema says BloomID

KEY IDEA

Before the irreversible switch, compare each schema with its sample file, field by field, using the design table, three files and a pen.

Can you undo Enable for Profile?

First: a primary identity is set

▼

Composition: click the schema name

▼

Schema properties: Profile toggle

▼

Warning: can't be disabled

▼

Click Enable, then Save

KEY IDEA

No. Once enabled and saved, a schema can't be disabled. The switch needs a primary identity first and belongs only on schemas you own.

Saved successfully, but Profile is off

What the screen said	What was true
Schema saved successfully	Identity kept, Profile flag dropped
Enabled for Profile column	Not enabled
The fix	Profile gets its own save, then look

KEY IDEA

Saving identities and the Profile flag in one Save can silently drop the flag. Give Profile its own save, then check the Browse list.

The truth lives in Schemas, Browse

Schema	Identities	Profile	Behavior
Customer Profile	1	Enabled	Record
Web Event	1	Enabled	Time-series
Order Event	2	Enabled	Time-series

Schemas, Browse, filtered on Bloom

KEY IDEA

The Browse list is the evidence: identities one, one and two, Enabled on all three, Record for the profile, Time-series for the events.

Interview corner: say it in one sentence

- “A schema without a primary identity is a spreadsheet.”
- Email is primary: it follows the person
- Order event: customer number plus email
- Proof comes from the Browse list

KEY IDEA

A schema without a primary identity is a spreadsheet. Back it with the email choice, the order event's two identities and the Browse check.

Recap, your question, and next time

- Namespace = kind of ID; its type is permanent
- Email is primary: it follows the person
- Identity, namespace, Primary, Apply, Save
- Profile: a one-way door with its own save
- Next: batch vs streaming, and Data Prep

KEY IDEA

Namespace types are permanent, email is primary, Apply then Save, and Profile needs its own save. Next: the data arrives.